

emerged as the most referenced skill area under 'Linux Job Demand', followed by Android, C++, J2EE and MySQL, in decreasing order.

New Android-powered TV for hospitals

HCI has released the next-generation RoomMate televisions, designed specifically for use in hospitals and other healthcare facilities.

The new connected television runs apps on an Android platform, much like a smartphone would, to entertain and educate patients, visitors, and staff. The Android connectivity will provide hospital patients, visitors and staff with a built-in browser, education and movies on demand, apps of all varieties, not to mention unparalleled reliability, making it the most advanced, most complete hospital-grade television available, globally.



Bengaluru hosts a hackathon for real-world challenges

In December, hackers in Bengaluru decided to help others by using their core competence and gathered together for a weekend hackathon called 'Hack for Humanity'. This was in sync with a global initiative, which was held in 31 cities by Random Hacks of Kindness (RHoK) on December 3-4, 2011. Random Hacks of Kindness (RHoK) is a community of innovators developing practical open technology solutions to the problems facing humanity. Technology experts gathered together at a seminar hall in M S Ramaiah Institute of Technology in Bengaluru to be a part of the weekend hackathon.

Teams were formed and the technology experts hacked away over the weekend. By Sunday afternoon there were approximately 30 hackers in 8 teams who presented their hacks. The top three hacks chosen were apps named '@iFile', 'twatboard', and 'New Way to Travel'. '@iFile' is an app for the efficient redressal of complaints, which uses simple SMS. Authorities can track and delegate complaints using Google Maps. 'twatboard' is an Arduino board-based app for tracking moving objects. Arduino is used as a microprocessor, and the combination of the hardware and software solution takes coordinates given by a GPS module and tweets the location using the GSM module. This simple app can help to track any moving object, like a school bus, pets, children, etc. 'New Way to Travel' is an app to help the visually challenged and the elderly to find a bus to a desired destination. The judges at RHoK were Rupesh from Intuit, Shyam from Dig Design Studio, and Ramesh Govind from Real Consultancy.

Bala Girisabala, director, Yahoo Entrepreneur Network, opened the event with a presentation on social initiatives and choosing the correct problems to solve. Rupesh Shah and Sreedhar Jagannath, Intuit, presented a well researched talk on the problems in the unorganised labour space. They gave the teams exercises to help them understand the challenges faced by low-skilled labour when it came to finding jobs, and the challenges employers face in finding the required skills.

Modular open source hardware from Tinkerforge

German start-up TinkerForge has come up with its open source modular system, which lets even novice users whip up fully functioning robots in a matter of hours. According to the company, one can plug sensor and actor modules together, and program the desired behaviour of the modules, without prior knowledge in hardware programming.

The new system of hardware building blocks can be used for the automation of processes or for the development of prototypes.

Create and customise your Cloud with the open source 'ownCloud'

An open source cloud program, ownCloud, has now formed a commercial entity founded by Markus Rex and Frank Karlitschek. ownCloud is an open source cloud program, which already has more than 350,000 users. Rex terms ownCloud as the only tool based on a ubiquitous open source platform in a cloud-oriented world.



Users can set up their own cloud server for file-sharing, music-streaming, and for calendar, contact, and bookmark-sharing projects. OwnCloud allows universal access of files through a Web browser via WebDAV, and also provides for easy viewing and syncing of contacts, calendars and bookmarks across all devices—even enabling basic editing rights on the Web. It allows programmers to add features to it via its open Application Programming Interface (API).